

Owl Hall: Comprehensive Q&A Guide

Reading Comprehension

Chapter 1 Chapter 1

1. **What time of day was it at the start of the story?** It was getting dark/evening as they were driving.
2. **Who is Martin?** Martin is Kara's younger brother.
3. **Where did Kara think they were going?** She thought they were going on a normal countryside holiday.
4. **Why could Mum not use her mobile phone to find their location?** Because there was no signal/reception in that remote area.
5. **How did Kara feel about Howard when she first saw him?** She felt uncomfortable; she thought he was strange and not very welcoming.
6. **What happened to the road sign?** It had been turned around or broken, making it difficult to find the way.

Chapter 2 Chapter 2

1. **Did Kara like Owl Hall when she first saw it?** No, she found it dark, old, and a bit scary.
2. **What did Kara notice in the courtyard?** She noticed it was neglected and had a heavy, unpleasant atmosphere.
3. **How many holiday homes were there at Owl Hall?** There was only one (the one they were staying in).
4. **What was on the wall of Kara's room?** There was a painting/decoration that she found disturbing.
5. **Could Kara log on to the Internet on the laptop?** No, there was no internet connection available.
6. **Why was Martin nervous at the end of the chapter?** He felt that something was wrong with the house and he was scared.

Chapter 3 Chapter 3

1. **Kara said to Mum, 'Are you worried I'm going to do something stupid again?' What do you think Kara meant?** She was referring to "the incident" that happened back home, suggesting her mother didn't trust her yet.
2. **What was Martin doing when Kara walked into the living room?** He was sitting quietly, looking withdrawn and strange.

3. **Did Mum want to talk about 'the incident' at breakfast?** No, she avoided the subject.
4. **What did Kara use to film the video?** She used her digital camera/phone.
5. **What did Kara think she saw when she filmed the barn?** She thought she saw a face or a figure watching her from the window.

Chapter 4 Chapter 4

1. **When did Martin's character start to change?** His character started to change after the traumatic incident they experienced months ago.
2. **Who did Kara and Martin think lived in the house on the hill?** They thought it was Howard or someone spying on them.
3. **What did they see when they watched the video?** They saw a shadow or a mysterious movement, confirming they weren't alone.
4. **Why did Mum ask Kara to make some tea?** To distract her and calm everyone down during a tense moment.

Chapter 5 The Climax (Chapters 10-12)

- **The Incident:** It is revealed that Martin was obsessed with fire and was responsible for a fire in their old home.
- **The Truth about Owl Hall:** It is not a holiday home, but a psychiatric clinic where Kara is receiving therapy to deal with the trauma of what happened to her family.
- **John's Identity:** John is revealed to be either a fellow patient or a figment of Kara's process of healing (depending on the interpretation of the doctor's methods).
- **The Ending:** Kara is encouraged to write her blog to process her feelings. The "Chapter Thirteen" mentioned by John represents her life after the clinic.